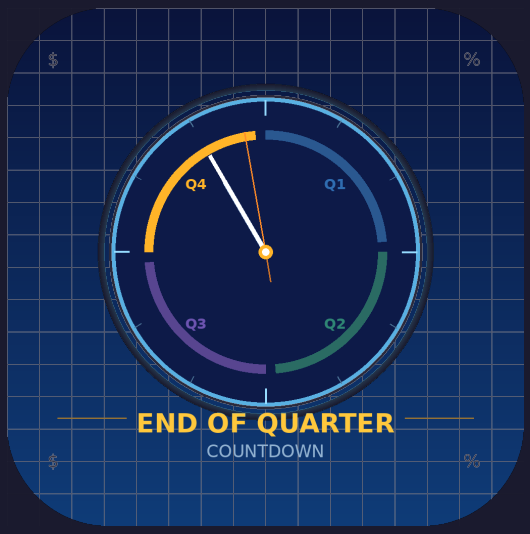
END OF QUARTER COUNTDOWN

macOS & Windows 11 App

USER GUIDE

Version 2.5.3

Ian Hawkins
ianhawki@cisco.com



Cisco Confidential

Table of Contents

Table of Contents 2
1. Overview 3
1.1 System Requirements 3
1.2 Key Features 3
2. The Menu Bar/System Tray Label 4
2.1 Mac Menu Bar Label Format 4
2.2 Windows System Tray Label Format 4
2.3 Warning State 5
3. The Popup Window 6
3.1 Header 6
3.2 Countdown Section 6
3.3 Quarter Progress Bar 6
3.4 Info Cards 6
3.5 New FY Warning Banner 7
3.6 Footer 7
4. Setting Quarter Dates 8
4.1 Web Sync (Recommended) 8
4.2 Manual Date Entry 9
5. Business Days vs Calendar Days 10
5.1 How It Affects the Display 10
6. Mac Desktop Widget 11
6.1 Widget Sizes 11
6.2 Adding the Widget 11
7. How Quarter Tracking Works 12
8. Launch at Login and Quitting 12
8.1 Launch at Login 12
8.2 Quitting the App 12
9. Installation 13
9.1 MacOS Installation 13
9.2 Windows 11 Installation 13
10. Github 14

Cisco Confidential

1. Overview

End of Quarter Countdown is a lightweight macOS menu bar or Windows 11 System Tray application that counts down to the end of your current financial quarter. It lives entirely in the menu bar on your Mac or System Tray in your Windows 11 — there is no Dock icon — and provides an at-a-glance view of days and weeks remaining in the quarter, along with a matching desktop widget for macOS Sonoma. (No widget for the Windows 11 Version)

1.1 System Requirements

MacOS	
Component	**Requirement**
Menu bar app	macOS 13.0 (Ventura) or later
Desktop widget	macOS 14.0 (Sonoma) or later
Processor	Apple Silicon or Intel Mac
Windows 11	
Windows 11	Node.js 18 or newer & npm (ships with Node.js)
Architecture	x64

1.2 Key Features

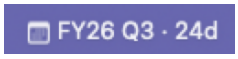
- MAC - Always-visible menu bar label showing FY, quarter and days remaining
  WIN – System Tray Icon with hover label showing FY, quarter and days remaining, Icon shows the days remaining.
- Dark-themed popup with full countdown detail, progress bar and info cards
- Choice of calendar days or business days (Mon–Fri) counting
- Web sync — automatically fetches quarter end dates from a configured URL
- Manual date editor for all five tracked quarters
- New FY warning banner when the rollover buffer is under 70 days
- Desktop widget in Small and Medium sizes (macOS 14+)
- Launch at Login support

Cisco Confidential

2. The Menu Bar/System Tray Label

2.1 Mac Menu Bar Label Format

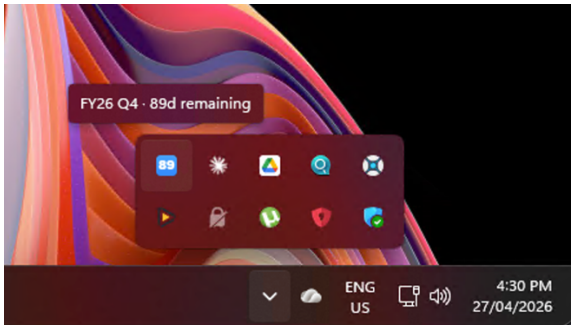
The top menu bar label is visible at all times at the top of your screen. It shows the current financial year, quarter number and days remaining.



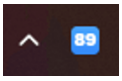
Component	Requirement
FY26 Q3 · 24d	Calendar days mode — all days including weekends
FY26 Q3 · 18bd	Business days mode — Monday–Friday only (bd suffix)

2.2 Windows System Tray Label Format

The System Tray label Appears as you hover over the App Icon. It shows the current financial year, quarter number and days remaining.



You can drag the App Icon next to the ^ in the System Tray to move the App from the Overflow Tray to the main System Tray. The App Icon shows the days remaining.

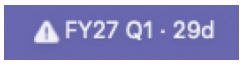


Component	Requirement
FY26 Q3 · 24d	Calendar days mode — all days including weekends
FY26 Q3 · 18bd	Business days mode — Monday–Friday only (bd suffix)

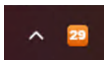
Cisco Confidential

2.3 Warning State

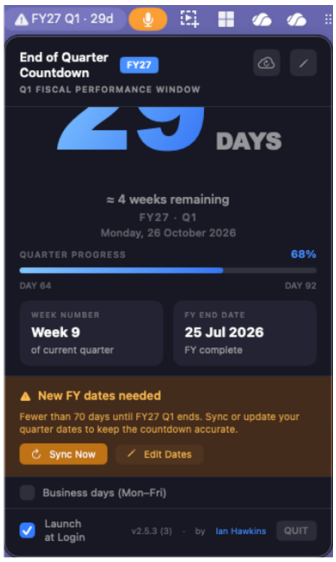
When fewer than 70 days remain on the next FY Q1 (the rollover buffer quarter), the menu bar icon changes to an orange warning triangle and the label turns orange. This indicates that new financial year dates need to be configured.



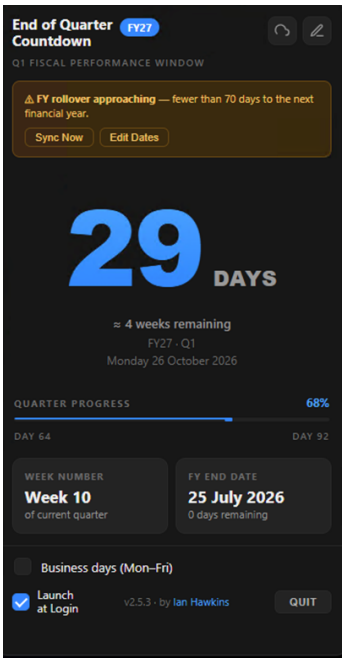
Mac



Windows



**Scroll under the day count to see options*

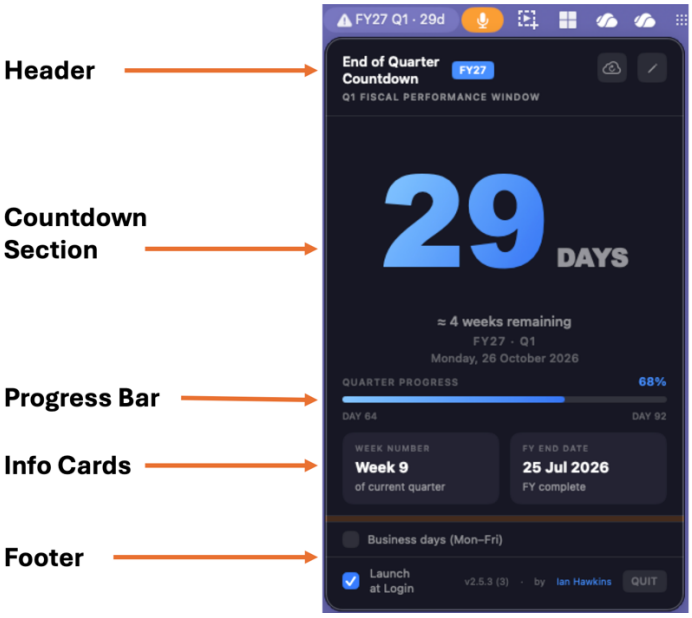


> **Note**
> Mac: Click anywhere on the menu bar label to open the full popup window. Win: Click on the app icon to open the full popup window.

Cisco Confidential

3. The Popup Window

Click the menu bar label or the Windows App icon to open the popup. The popup has a fixed layout: the header and footer are always visible, and the main content area scrolls if needed.



3.1 Header

The header runs across the top of the popup and contains:

- The app title “End of Quarter Countdown” with a coloured FY badge (e.g. FY26)
- A quarter subtitle (e.g. “Q3 FISCAL PERFORMANCE WINDOW”)
- Cloud sync button (top right) — fetches dates from the web
- Pencil / edit button (top right) — opens the date editor

3.2 Countdown Section

The main countdown display shows:

- A large number showing the days remaining, with a “DAYS” label alongside
- Approximate weeks remaining (e.g. “≈ 8 weeks remaining”)
- The FY and quarter identifier (e.g. “FY26 · Q3”)
- The full end-of-quarter date in long format (e.g. “Saturday, 25 April 2026”)

3.3 Quarter Progress Bar

Below the countdown, a progress bar shows how far through the current quarter you are:

- A percentage label on the right (e.g. 72%)
- A filled bar proportional to elapsed time
- DAY X on the left end and DAY Y on the right end, showing your position in the quarter

3.4 Info Cards

Two cards sit side by side below the progress bar:

Cisco Confidential

- WEEK NUMBER (left) — the current week number within the quarter
- FY END DATE (right) — the financial year end date and the number of days remaining until it

3.5 New FY Warning Banner

When fewer than 70 days remain on the next FY Q1 entry, an amber warning banner appears between the info cards and the footer:

- A message indicating that new FY dates are needed
- A Sync Now button to fetch updated dates automatically
- An Edit Dates button to open the date editor

> **Tip**
> The warning only appears for the next-FY Q1 entry — the rollover buffer quarter. It is designed to give you time to update your dates before the current FY ends.

3.6 Footer

The footer is always visible at the bottom of the popup and contains:

- Business days checkbox — tick to count Mon–Fri only; untick for calendar days
- Launch at Login checkbox
- Version number
- QUIT button — the only way to quit the app (it has no Dock icon)

Cisco Confidential

4. Setting Quarter Dates

The app tracks five quarter end dates: Q1–Q4 of the current financial year, plus Q1 of the next financial year as a rollover buffer. Dates can be set via web sync or manually.

4.1 Web Sync (Recommended)

The quickest way to configure dates is to sync from a URL that lists them in the required format.

To sync from the default URL:

1. Click the menu bar label to open the popup
2. Click the cloud sync icon in the top-right of the header
3. Dates are fetched and applied automatically

To use a custom URL:

4. Click the menu bar label to open the popup
5. Click the pencil icon to open the date editor
6. Locate the Sync URL field at the top of the editor
7. Enter your URL and click Save
8. Click the cloud sync icon to fetch dates from the new URL

Required URL format

The sync page must list one quarter per line in this exact format:

```
FY26Q1 : 25/10/2025
FY26Q2 : 25/01/2026
FY26Q3 : 25/04/2026
FY26Q4 : 25/07/2026
FY27Q1 : 25/10/2026
```

> **Important**
> The fifth entry must be the next financial year's Q1. This acts as a rollover buffer and triggers the 70-day warning banner when it is approaching.

Default sync URL:

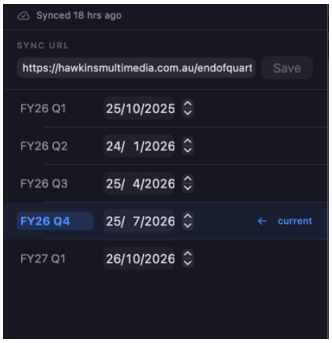
https://hawkinsmultimedia.com.au/endofquarter.html

Cisco Confidential

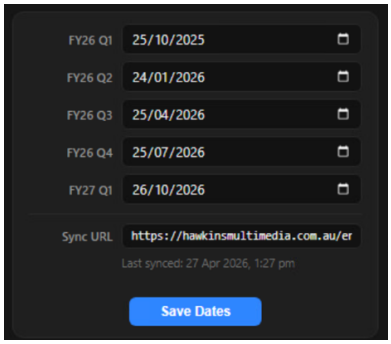
4.2 Manual Date Entry

You can set dates directly using the date editor.

Mac



Windows



1. Click the menu bar label or the System Tray App to open the popup
2. Click the pencil icon in the top-right of the header
3. The countdown view is replaced by the date editor, showing all five quarters
4. The currently active quarter is highlighted in blue on the Mac version.
5. Click any date picker to change the end date for that quarter
6. Dates save automatically as you change them on the Mac, Windows Version, please press the Save Dates button.
7. Click the checkmark button or close and reopen the popup to return to the countdown view

> **Tip**
> The editor shows a sync status line indicating when dates were last fetched from the web, or whether a sync error occurred.

Cisco Confidential

5. Business Days vs Calendar Days

The app offers two counting modes, toggled via the checkbox in the footer of the popup.

Component	Requirement
Unticked (default)	Calendar days — all days including Saturday and Sunday
Ticked	Business days — Monday to Friday only

5.1 How It Affects the Display

- The menu bar label shows a “bd” suffix in business days mode (e.g. “18bd” instead of “24d”)
- The DAYS count in the popup reflects the selected mode
- Weeks remaining is divided by 5 in business days mode, or by 7 in calendar days mode
- The desktop widget automatically mirrors this setting — no separate configuration needed

> **Note**
> Switching modes takes effect immediately. No restart is required.

Cisco Confidential

6. Mac Desktop Widget

A desktop widget is available for macOS 14.0 (Sonoma) or later. It comes in two sizes and automatically stays in sync with the main app.

6.1 Widget Sizes

Small Widget

- FY badge (e.g. FY26)
- Large countdown number with “d” or “bd” suffix
- Quarter label (e.g. FY26 Q3)
- Weeks remaining

Medium Widget

- Everything in the small widget, plus:
  - Quarter progress bar with percentage
  - Day X of Y indicator
  - Weeks left
  - FY end date
  - “BUS DAYS” label instead of “DAYS” when in business days mode

6.2 Adding the Widget

1. Make sure the app has been run at least once from the Applications folder
2. Right-click an empty area of your desktop
3. Click Edit Widgets
4. Search for “Quarter Countdown”
5. Click the + button or drag the Small or Medium widget to your desktop

> **Note**
> The widget updates automatically at midnight each day. It reads all settings — dates, FY labels, and the business/calendar days preference — directly from the shared data store used by the main app. No separate widget configuration is needed.

Cisco Confidential

7. How Quarter Tracking Works

The app tracks five quarter end dates at all times:

Component	Requirement
Q1	End date for Quarter 1 of the current financial year
Q2	End date for Quarter 2 of the current financial year
Q3	End date for Quarter 3 of the current financial year
Q4	End date for Quarter 4 of the current financial year
Q1*	End date for Quarter 1 of the NEXT financial year (rollover buffer)

The app automatically determines the current quarter by finding the first end date that is still in the future. When a quarter ends, the app immediately advances to the next one with no manual intervention required.

The fifth entry (next FY Q1) ensures there is no gap at financial year rollover. It also drives the 70-day warning: when fewer than 70 days remain on this entry, the warning banner and orange icon appear, prompting you to update your dates for the coming year.

8. Launch at Login and Quitting

8.1 Launch at Login

To start the app automatically each time you log in to your Mac:

1. Open the popup by clicking the Mac menu bar label or click on the App icon on the Windows System Tray
2. Tick the Launch at Login checkbox in the footer

To disable automatic startup, untick the same checkbox.

8.2 Quitting the App

To quit:

1. Click the Mac menu bar label or the Windows System Tray to open the popup
2. Click the QUIT button in the footer

> **Note**
> If Launch at Login is enabled, the app will restart automatically the next time you log in, even after quitting.

Cisco Confidential

9. Installation

9.1 MacOS Installation

Download the app from https://hawkinsmultimedia.com.au/software. Look for the latest version in the MacOS section.

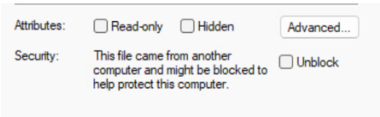
Application v2.5.3

1	Unzip the downloaded file.
2	Move ‘End of Quarter Countdown.app’ to your Applications folder.
3	Double-click to launch. MacOS may ask for permission on first run — click Open.
4	The calendar icon appears in the menu bar. No Dock icon is shown.
5	Use the Cloud Sync to collect the current Fiscal Year data or create custom dates using the date editor panel (sliders icon) function. It is designed to automatically do this on first run.
6	If you wish the application to launch on start-up, Tick the ‘Launch at Login’ box on the popup panel.

9.2 Windows 11 Installation

Download the app from https://hawkinsmultimedia.com.au/software. Look for the latest version in the Windows section.

Application v2.5.3

1	Unzip the downloaded file. Double Click the Installer file inside the Zip folder.
2	A Desktop Shortcut will get created and you should see the App Running in the System Tray.
3	Windows may block the installation, right click the installer and select Properties. At the bottom of the properties panel, tick the Unblock function under Security. 
4	The calendar icon appears in the System Tray. No Dock icon is shown.
5	Use the Cloud Sync to collect the current Fiscal Year data or create custom dates using the date editor panel (sliders icon) function. It is designed to automatically do this on first run.

Cisco Confidential

6	If you wish the application to launch on start-up, Tick the 'Launch at Login' box on the popup panel.

10. Github

https://github.com/ianhawki?tab=repositories

Cisco Confidential